

resources consumed by apps, a task-killer to give you specific control over the active processes in the background (be careful while using this), and also the ability to backup application APKs and move apps to your memory card if your internal storage is running low.

book and the likes can save a lot of memory and processor load, along with decreasing network usage to simultaneously improve battery stamina. Disable automatic app refresh from Settings - Apps, and switch to manual. Once you see the effect for yourself, you can consider switching a neces-

even a factory reset would not give you anything more than a brief phase of significantly improved performance and more free space (the worst case situation is if you get stuck with 8GB of internal storage and no expandable slot). Additionally, doing a factory reset when the going gets tough does not really

and at the end of the day, you are left with barely one or two that we regularly connect to. The same goes with the list of Bluetooth devices. This often takes up a considerable amount of memory, and the best way to clean this up is by resetting Network settings from Settings - General - Reset - Reset

Use a low-resource custom launcher like Nova

Often, a very decked-up interface can be the root cause of the stutters on your phone. While highly customised launchers look really good, they are very high on memory consumption. In such situations, try out launchers like Nova - a lightweight, highly customisable Android launcher. Nova is fast, and you can customise it exactly to your requirements, meaning that you can easily optimise the performance to conserve memory.

Control internet access of specific apps with IF by IFTTT

IF by IFTTT is an action-based optimising app that focuses on Internet access control of specific apps. This can decrease a lot of load on processes, as it bars certain apps from accessing the network, simultaneously decreasing load. For instance, you can choose to get Daily Edition alerts from Flipboard, but prevent the e-commerce portal apps on your phone from accessing the Internet unless you explicitly require it to.

Set communication apps' refresh frequency to manual

Setting the app refresh frequency and barring push notifications of communication apps like Email, WhatsApp, Face-

sary few back on, to optimise your phone's performance.

If all fails, go for a Factory Reset

As we have been doing with our PCs for the longest time, it is time for a clean reboot of your phone, if none of the above-mentioned steps help you out. Backup your necessary data, and reset your device to factory settings. Your phone will boot right from scratch, meaning that you will possibly need to install a number of updates, download plenty of your everyday apps and key in your saved passwords after it, but the effort is worth it if your Android device is showing significant amounts of struggle. Chances are high that if the previous steps did not significantly ease stutters and free up memory on your phone,

have an adverse effect on your device, so getting your device thoroughly cleaned once in a while is actually a good idea.

iOS

Over time and with the latest features catering to the more powerful iPhone 6s, you'll find older generation iPhones do tend to lag. Although iOS does not allow you a deep level control over your OS the way Android does, here are a few simple yet effective tricks to speed up your iPhone, particularly if you're using devices older than the iPhone 6.

Reset network settings and connect to only relevant networks/devices

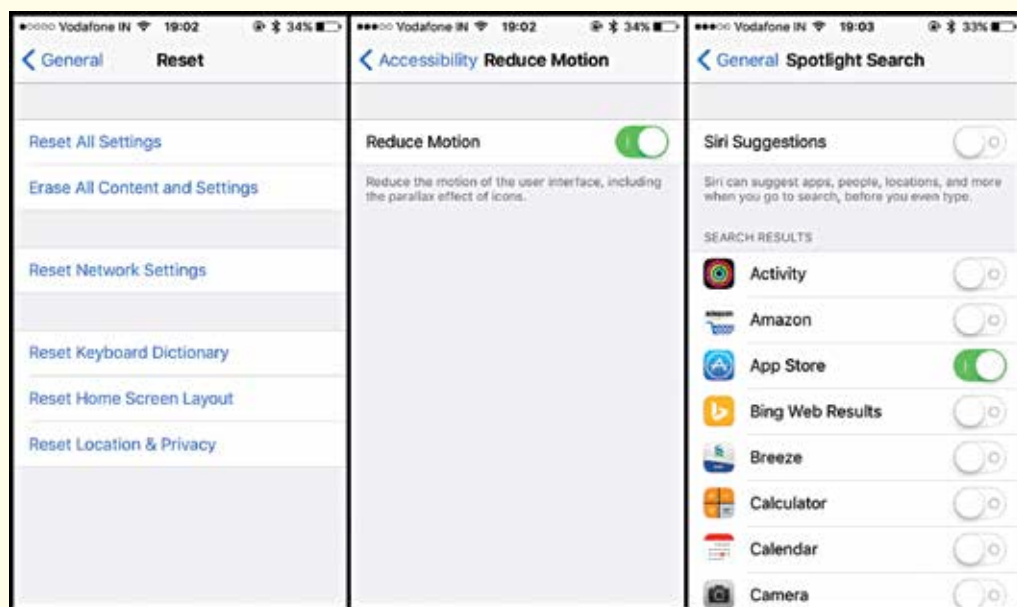
Over time, we end up connecting to too many network hotspots,

Network Settings. This can also speed up your device, with the cleaned up cache memory.

Reduce/disable transparency and motion to improve usability

While iOS has a number of neat visual effects, they generally take a toll on memory and constantly engage your iPhone's GPU. For instance, the constant parallax effect of icons floating on top of your wallpaper and the 'Perspective' wallpapers themselves may be a reason for your older generation iPhone slowing down. Try the following steps to remove the graphic tweaks and improve overall speed:

- Go to Settings - Wallpaper - New Wallpaper - Stills/Custom Image. From here, select your still image, and choose 'Still'



(L-R) Reset Network settings to remove cached network IDs, Reduce Motion, Turn Off Siri Suggestions